

Jothi Learning White Paper Series

THE JOTHI TUTOR ACADEMY

Executive Foundation

A structured system for developing high-performance academic tutors

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Intended Audience	Academy leadership, mentors, tutors, and internal stakeholders

1. Purpose

This document sets out the executive foundation of the Joithi Tutor Academy. It explains why the academy exists, what problem it solves, and how its components form a coherent tutor development system.

JF01 is the system map. It points to the documents that define each layer in detail. Read it first. Then go to the relevant JF, JTS, or JTD document for operational detail.

Related Documents

Series	Documents	Function
JF	JF01, JF02, JF03	Foundation — philosophy, teaching model, system overview
JTS	JTS01–JTS05	Teaching Standards — what good Joithi teaching looks like in practice
JTD	JTD01–JTD06	Tutor Development — competencies, residency, observation, certification

2. The Problem the Academy Solves

Most tutoring organisations recruit on subject knowledge and assume strong academic performance produces strong teaching. It does not.

Knowing a subject is not the same as explaining it clearly, diagnosing misunderstanding, or building durable student thinking. Without a structured development system, tutor quality varies between individuals, misconceptions go uncorrected, and scale weakens consistency.

The Jothis Tutor Academy exists to make high-quality tutoring trainable and repeatable — not dependent on individual instinct.

3. System Architecture

The academy is built as a layered system. Each layer depends on the ones beneath it. Together they ensure that teaching quality is defined, trainable, observable, and certifiable.

Layer	Document(s)	What It Does
Philosophy	JF02	The Jothis Trifecta defines the three conditions that make learning effective: Strategy, Mindset, and Environment. It is the philosophical foundation beneath every teaching and development decision.
Instructional Model	JF03	The 4T Teaching Engine — Teach, Test, Track, Transform — translates the Trifecta philosophy into a repeatable lesson cycle. It is the instructional spine of every Jothis lesson.
Teaching Standards	JTS01–JTS05	Five operational standards define what good Jothis teaching looks like in practice: lesson delivery, digital board use, assessment, parent communication, and teaching environment.
Competency Framework	JTD01	22 competencies across six domains (A–F) define what tutors must be able to do. Competencies are mapped to three development levels — JCT1 Core, JCT2 Developing, JCT3 Advanced — and drive sign-off decisions.
Residency Pathway	JTD03	Four residency stages — Observation, Co-Teaching, Lead Teaching, Independent Teaching — structure how tutors develop through increasing teaching responsibility. Progression is evidence-based, not time-based.
Development Tools	JTD02, JTD04, JTD05	Tutor reflection (JTD02), mentor observation (JTD04), and the evidence dashboard (JTD05) provide the Plan–Teach–Reflect–Improve loop that drives development at every stage.
Certification	JTD06	The certification and sign-off standard defines the criteria, decision process, and recording requirements for confirming a tutor is ready for independent teaching.

4. How Tutors Develop

The residency pathway moves tutors from structured observation to certified independent teaching. It follows a consistent internal rhythm at every stage:

Stage	What Happens
Observation	The tutor watches experienced teaching through the 4T lens. The goal is active noticing — not passive watching. No teaching responsibility.
Co-Teaching	The tutor leads short planned sections (15–20 minutes) with the mentor present. JCT1 core competencies begin to develop. The Plan–Teach–Reflect–Improve loop starts here.
Lead Teaching	The tutor leads progressively longer lessons (30 → 45 → 60 minutes) with mentor observation. JCT1 competencies should be consistent by the end of this stage. JCT2 competencies develop.
Independent Teaching	The tutor runs a full 6-week teaching cycle — planning, teaching, assessing, and communicating progress — under continued mentor oversight. JCT2 consolidates. JCT3 emerges. Certification evidence is built here.

Progression between stages is confirmed by the mentor panel after reviewing accumulated evidence. Time in a stage does not determine readiness. Demonstrated teaching competency does.

5. The Role of Mentors

Mentors are not supervisors who watch and approve. They are active developers who shape how tutors grow.

- Observe live teaching using the 4T lens and the JTD04 form
- Provide specific, evidence-based feedback — one improvement target per lesson
- Sign off competencies when repeated observable evidence supports it
- Sit on the mentor panel that makes progression and certification decisions
- Calibrate with other mentors to keep sign-off standards consistent across the cohort

The quality of mentoring determines the quality of the academy's output. A poorly calibrated mentor weakens the entire system — not just one tutor's development.

6. What This System Protects Against

Risk	How the System Addresses It
Inconsistent teaching quality	The JTS series defines a shared standard. All tutors are trained and observed against the same expectation.
Subjective mentor judgement	The A-F competency framework gives mentors shared criteria. The mentor panel provides a collective check on individual judgements.
Premature certification	Certification requires evidence across all three JCT levels and a collective mentor panel decision. Time served does not trigger it.
Tutors teaching off-topic	A4 Curriculum and School Alignment Awareness is a JCT1 competency. Tutors must check school context before deciding lesson content.

Risk	How the System Addresses It
Quality decline as the academy grows	The system creates a common language, shared standards, and structured sign-off. Growth does not require relaxing the standard.

7. Version Notes — Changes from v1.0

Change	Reason
Architecture presented as a table, not a linear flowchart	The flowchart in v1.0 implied a one-directional dependency. The table makes each layer's function and document reference visible at a glance.
Competency framework updated to A-F domain structure	v1.0 described competencies in JCT1/JCT2/JCT3 tiers only. v2.0 reflects the revised A-F taxonomy in JTD01 v2.0.
Residency stages named explicitly as canonical terms	Observation, Co-Teaching, Lead Teaching, Independent Teaching are the standard JTA stage names used across all v2.0 documents and SKOOL modules.
Mentor role tightened	v1.0 described mentors in general terms. v2.0 specifies the five operational responsibilities that make the mentor role meaningful.
'What this system protects against' section added	New in v2.0. Makes the practical value of the architecture explicit, not just the structure of it.
Motivational and scale-narrative sections removed	v1.0 included multiple paragraphs on why quality matters and why scale requires systems. These were obvious. Removed.

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